could not be verified by any source. Reportedly, Sivarasan never used that alias.

Thinking the IB would have more information on Padmanabha's killers, Anirudhya met his IB friend and asked about Nalini, Murugan, Raghuvaran, David, Sivarajan and Sivarasan. Did they ring any bells? Whatever Anirudhya had gathered from the SIT about the Padmanabha assassination case was confirmed by his IB source, except that it could not furnish a photograph of David or Raghuvaran. Also, the IB had no clue about Nalini, Murugan and Sivarasan, although the intelligence outfit knew that Raghuvaran was a top operative of the LTTE and had lost an eye in one of his missions. Ever since, he had been referred to as the 'One-Eyed Rajah' within his close circle. Could it be that Rajah, Sivarasan and Sivarajan were all one person? His IB friend could not confirm this but felt it was worth looking into. But what had made the IB not follow up and procure a photograph of David and Raghuvaran? There was no answer to that. The CID had investigated the Padmanabha case under IG R. Nagarajan. Everybody knew the investigation had come under the scanner. Nagarajan was suspected of having been in cahoots with the perpetrators of the crime. He was eventually arrested for botching up the investigation.

On 30 May the SIT released Haribabu's photograph of the female assassin and the mysterious kurta-pyjama-clad man in the newspapers. It asked people to contact the SIT on the telephone numbers given and share any information they may have on those seen in the photograph. The identity of the informant would be kept confidential.

The telephone lines did not stop ringing for the next forty-eight hours. A section of the CBI staff painstakingly noted down everything the callers had to say and read through all the letters and telegrams that came in. Some callers claimed they had seen the kurta-pyjama-clad man in an autorickshaw; some said he was spotted on a train; some said he had been seen travelling by bus; and some claimed he stayed in their neighbourhood. Some of the information received led to raids and detentions. But nothing significant came to light until a man in his forties arrived in Malligai and claimed he had come with 'concrete information'.